

months. Since I have to constantly improve myself, everyday 20-30 per cent of my time is spent on learning new things. There's never any monotony.

Sometimes, to work on specific projects, one also goes outside the country. I have already been to Korea, Spain and the U.S.

What are your three or four attributes which you think have really helped you in this career? What advice would you give based on this to people? The job requires constant learning and hence one has to be diligent, patient, and always eager to learn.

Are there things one could do to grow faster in this profession?

There's only one thing you can do — learn, learn and learn. There are no short cuts here. One usually starts as a project manager and then moves on to become a developer, may be in 6-7 years time a team leader and then in 10 years time you can become a project manager. One has to keep specialising in solving bottle necks in designing and the only thing that helps is learning and applying that learning. Hence, no shortcuts.

How easy is it to change careers after some time? Are there natural cross-roads? What are some usual transitions people make/can make?

The career choices that you can make, one gets to make right at the beginning. As a fresher you can choose to enter any of the embedded design industries. But then the software design of most products is very specific to that product. Maybe one can jump between companies if both of them make the same type of product, say cell phones, but beyond that one does not have much flexibility. Though there are opportunities to switch to the management side of the firm you are working in. On the technology side, one switch that is possible at a later stage is the switch from the chip design industry to the EDA tool industry. Otherwise it makes sense to become a domain expert.

What future prospects do you see in this career? What are the emerging hot areas within this sector/profession?

There are constant product innovations that are required and hence there is constant scope for growth. For example, when the iPhone was launched, other companies wanted to make phones that could provide even more functions than the iPhone and yet have an equally eye-catching interface. Similarly for phones at the lower end, companies require a product differentiator and hence the growth in the sector is assured.

Compensation-

○ Trainee	-	3-4.5 lakh
○ Mid-level	-	8-14 lakh
○ Project Manager	-	16-20 lakh per annum

Please note: These figures do not represent the compensation package of any one company. It is an approximate based on discussions with experts across companies.

Rahul Hakhoo is one of those rare people who has been in the semiconductor business for nearly 25 years. He started

**Learn more from
practitioners and
experts.**

8th ANNIVERSARY
CARNIVAL

Attend
Free
Interactive
Webinar
on

**Careers in
Embedded
Design**

Visit
thinkdigit.com/calender
for
details & registration.
For free updates,
SMS Join DigitIndia
to 567678